

ANCIENT HISTORY



MODULE - 14

MAURYAN DYNASTY
PART-2

OUR APPROACH TO FIND HISTORY FROM MYSTERY?

PRE - HISTORY

The period of time before written records.

- Stone Age
- Metal Age

PROTO - HISTORY

IVC

Aryan Invasion

VEDIC AGE
(1500 – 500 B.C.)

EARLY VEDIC AGE
(1500 – 1000 B.C.)

LATER VEDIC AGE
(1000 – 500 B.C.)

RELIGION & PHILOSOPHY



JAINISM



BUDDHISM

HISTORIC PERIOD

MAHAJANAPADAS

TERRITORIAL EXPANSION

MAGADHA

NANDA DYNASTY

Alexander Invasion

MAURYAN DYNASTY

MAURYAN DYNASTY

GUPTA DYNASTY

Foreign Invasion

KUSHAN EMPIRE

SATAVAHANAS

PUSHYABHUTHI DYNASTY

Huns Invasion

CHALUKYAS

PALLAVAS

SANGAM AGE

CHOLA

CHERA

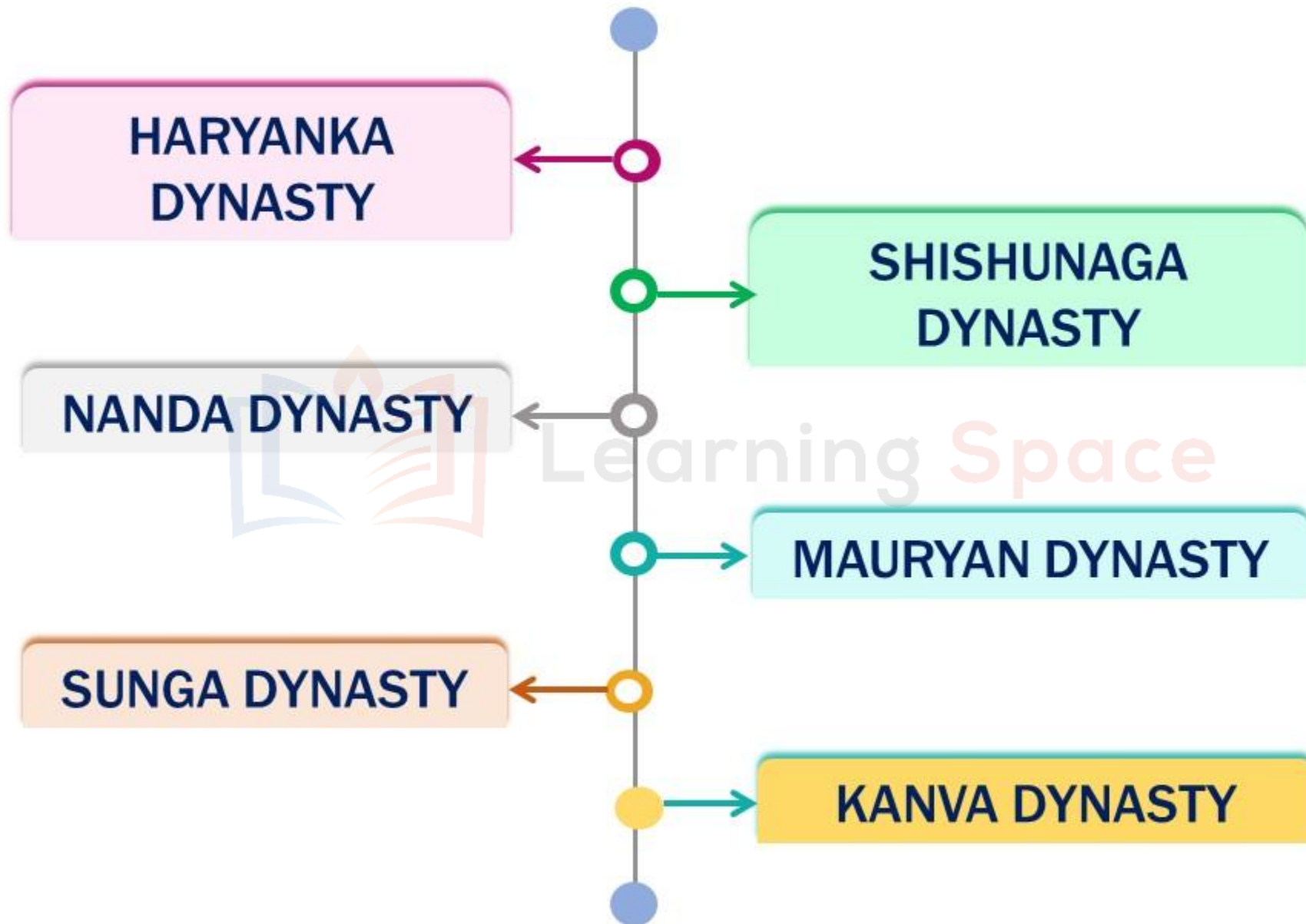
PANDYA

MAUKHARIS

VAKATAKAS

KADAMBAS

MAGADHAN DYNASTIES





MAURYAN DYNASTY

321BC – 185 BC

ABOUT THE DYNASTY

SOURCES

KINGS AND THEIR CONTRIBUTION

CONSOLIDATION OF EMPIRE AND TERRITORIAL EXTENT

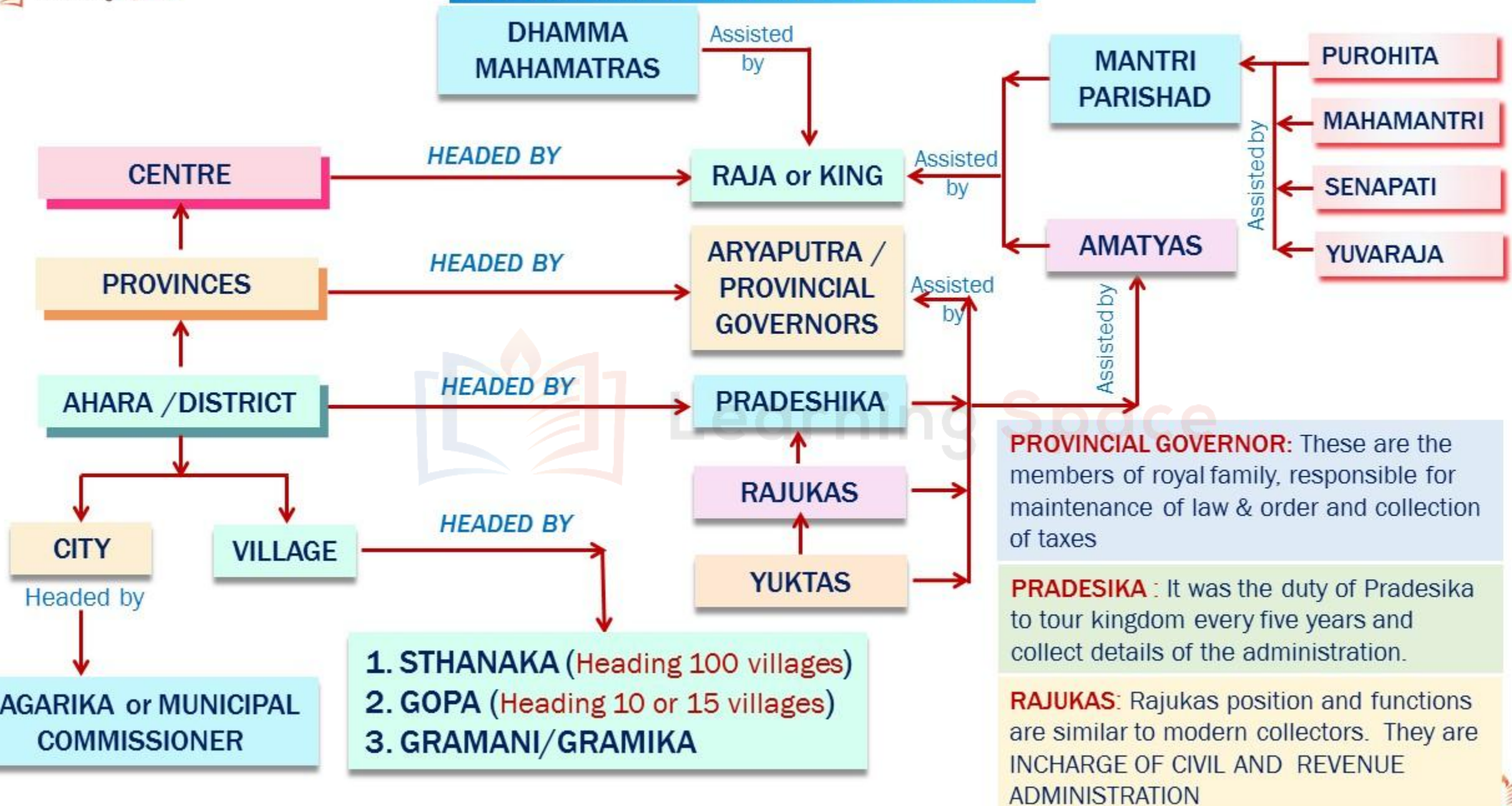
POLITICAL STRUCTURE/ SOCIAL LIFE/ ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENT

SIGNIFICANCE OF THE DYNASTY

HOW DYNASTY DECLINED

OTHER FACTS

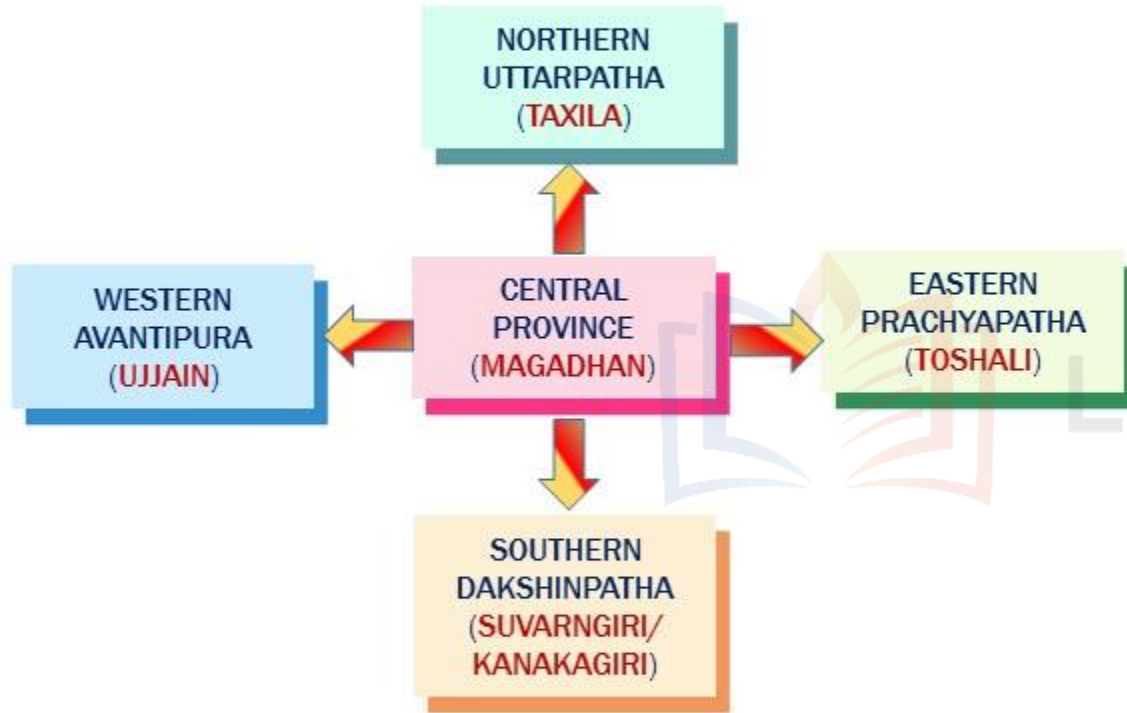
MAURYAN POLITICAL STRUCTURE



MAURYAN DYNASTY

(321 BC TO 185 BC)

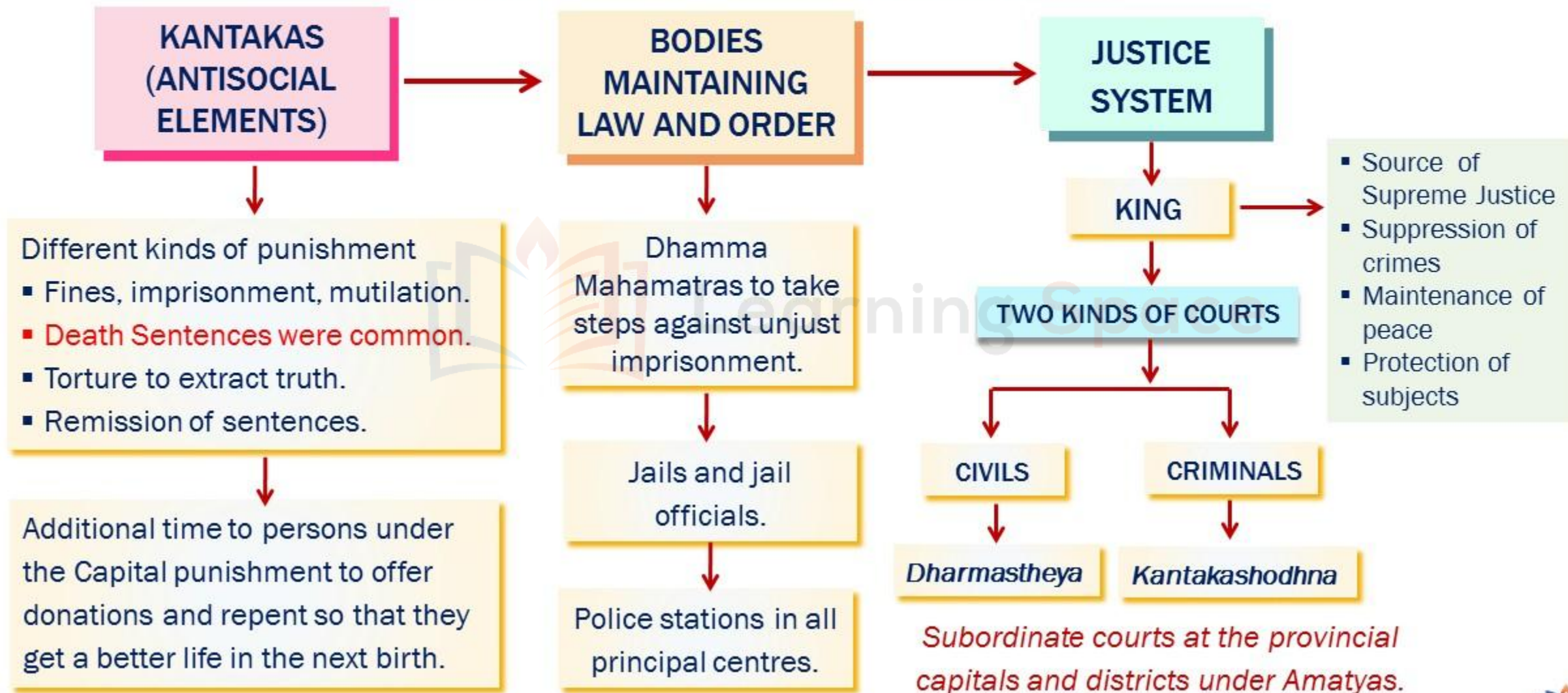
MAURYAN POLITY - PROVINCES



MAURYAN DYNASTY

(321 BC TO 185 BC)

MAURYAN POLITY - LAW AND ORDER



MAURYAN DYNASTY

(321 BC TO 185 BC)

MAURYAN POLITY

GUDHAPURUSA OR SPIES

SANSTHANA (stationary)



1 Well-developed espionage system.

2 Two kind of spies viz. **Sansthana** (stationary) and **Sanchari** (wandering).

SANCHARI (wandering)



3 Agents included householders, merchants, disciples, ascetics, pensioners and **Poisonous girls** called "**Vishkanyas**".

4 Ambassadors who were appointed in foreign countries were also sort of spies.

5 A new officers, **Prativedakas**, were employed to keep Ashoka informed about the happenings all around.

MAURYAN DYNASTY

(321 BC TO 185 BC)

MAURYAN POLITY - MILITARY



Each wing was under the control of Adyakshas or Superintendents.

- 1 Well organized military under control of **Senapati**.
- 2 **Megasthenes** mentions six boards of five members each to control the **six wings of the military**.
- 3 According to Greek author Pliny, Mauryan army consisted of six lakh infantry, thirty thousand cavalry, nine thousand elephants and eight thousand chariots.
- 4 Salaries were paid in cash.

MAURYAN ERA

MILITARY - 6 WINGS



CAVALRY



ELEPHANTS



INFANTARY



NAVY



CHARIOTS



TRANSPORT &
SUPPLY

MAURYAN DYNASTY

(321 BC TO 185 BC)

MAURYAN POLITY - OTHER FUNCTIONARIES

CENSUS OFFICER



CENSUS

- 1
 - Census was a **regular exercise** and appears to be a **permanent institution**.
 - It is conducted in villages (**by village officials**) and town(**by Nagarika**).

- 2 Along with the people, data of farmers, cattle, traders, cowherds, caste and occupation, deaths and births etc. was recorded.
- 3 The data collected were **cross checked by the spies**.
- 4 Census was done for
 - To **ensure that proper tax is levied**.
 - To **track movement of population** both foreign and indigenous.

MAURYAN DYNASTY

(321 BC TO 185 BC)

MAURYAN POLITY

OTHER FUNCTIONARIES



- 1 There were proper hospitals and *Bheshajas* (Doctors) appointed along with a team of midwives, nurses etc.
- 2 Treatment was *free* universally
- 3 Food adulteration was a punishable offense which invited a death sentence.

MAURYAN DYNASTY

(321 BC TO 185 BC)

MAURYAN ECONOMY

BUDGET WAS PREPARED

Means financial
accountancy
was there

REVENUE

EXPENDITURE

TAX

TRIBUTE

TRADE

BHAGA
(LAND TAX)

OTHER
TAXES

BALI
(LAND TRIBUTE)

INTERNAL
TRADE

FOREIGN
TRADE

VOLUNTARY GIFT

- 1/6 (Shadbhaga or rajbhaga) to 1/4 of the produce
- More productive lands and irrigated lands invited more tax.

- Hiranya (tax paid in cash/gold)
- Pindakara (tax on animal husbandry)
- Shop tax
- Ferry tax
- Fee & Fine

- Maintenance of Royal palaces, members, ministers
- Army, government servants, public works, poor relief, religion, etc.
- Public welfare were main avenues to use the revenue.

Asoka edict says that Lumbini was exempted from Bali and Bhaga was reduced to 1/8 parts.

MAURYAN DYNASTY

(321 BC TO 185 BC)

MAURYAN ECONOMY

FOREIGN TRADE



- 1 Both by land and sea was prevalent, and regulated by passports kinds of documents.
- 2 Indigo, cotton and silk was most traded property.
- 3 Mauryan Economy was world's largest economy and currency of Mauryas was accepted worldwide and was main currency of that time.
- 4 Trade routes were called Vanikpatha.

MAURYAN DYNASTY

(321 BC TO 185 BC)

MAURYAN ECONOMY- DEPARTMENT

1 REVENUE DEPARTMENT

Samharta, chief of
Revenue Department

*1/6TH
OF THE
PRODUCE*

2 DEPARTMENT OF COMMERCE AND INDUSTRY

- Controlled retail and wholesale prices of goods
- Ensure steady supply through its officers called **Adyakshas**.
- It also controlled weights and measures, **levied custom duties and regulate foreign trade**.

3 TRANSPORT DEPARTMENT

- There was a separate department of road.
- There were **trunk roads** which were managed by the department of Roads.

MAURYAN DYNASTY

(321 BC TO 185 BC)

MAURYAN ECONOMY- TRANSPORT

1 Width of cattle tracks, pedestrians, chariots and other traffic were different.

2 Trees were planted on both sides of the roads.



3 Inns were constructed at places along the road sides.

4 Nurseries and drinking water facilities such as wells, canals were provided.



MAURYAN DYNASTY

(321 BC TO 185 BC)

SOCIAL LIFE

CASTE SYSTEM

- 1 Well-developed “caste” system existed as per Megasthenes.
- 2 He mentioned seven castes viz. philosophers (Brahmins), farmers, soldiers, herdsman, craftsmen, magistrates and soldiers.
- 3 Caste system was based upon “occupation” rather than birth.
- 4 There was no slavery and people used to work as *dasa*, out of their own compulsions.

WOMEN

- 1 Polygamy was confined to Royal classes.
- 2 Women had their property in the form of *Stridhana*, which included bridal gift.
- 3 Women enjoyed high status. They were appointed as assistances and bodyguards of King.

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MAURYAN DYNASTY

(321 BC TO 185 BC)

CAUSES OF DECLINE



They feared of losing their importance, hence supported Sunga rule (patronized Brahminism) who overthrew Mauryans.

1

Asoka's pro-Buddhist policies antagonized Brahmins.

- Prohibited killing of birds and animals and other superfluous rituals performed by them.
- Anti-sacrifice attitude affected income of Brahmins.
- Edicts were in prakrit (not in Brahmanical language Sanskrit.)
- Appointed Rajukas to govern and introduce vyaharasamhita and Dandsamhita which meant same civil and criminal laws for all varnas as against to Dharmashastra of Brahmin which had varna discrimination.

MAURYAN DYNASTY

(321 BC TO 185 BC)

CAUSES OF DECLINE

2 Financial crisis

- Enormous expenditure of army and bureaucracy
- Large donation to Buddhist made royal treasure empty.



Towards the end they were obliged to melt gold coins to meet their expenses.

3 Oppressive rule of wicked bureaucrats

- In spite of many measure like rotation of officers, deploying spies, rulers could not check the exploitative nature.



Healthy and vigorous empire began suffering from a malaise under corrupt Amathyas

MAURYAN DYNASTY

(321 BC TO 185 BC)

CAUSES OF DECLINE

4 Neglect of north west frontiers

- Ashoka was primarily preoccupied with missionary activities and could not pay much attention to vulnerable passes in north west India which later paved way for greek invasion.
- Lack of futuristic policies to defend the frontiers like that of china who constructed a great wall to prevent foreign invasion.

5 **New knowledge** (like use of iron to make tools and weapons) **spread to the peripheral province**. On the basis of this acquired material culture, new kingdoms began to emerge.

6 **Asoka's policy of non-violence** reduced fighting spirit of his army was another charge against him. But Asoka never slackened his control over his empire despite following a pacifist policy.

7 **Weak successors** could not handle the highly centralised administration

8 **Administrative abuses** after Asoka's reign.

9 After the **death of Asoka**, Maurya territories were partitioned into two parts viz. east and west. This disturbed the unity of the empire.

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MAURYAN DYNASTY

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SIGNIFICANCE

1 SOCIAL SIGNIFICANCE

1 Rapid development and **spread of material culture** which was predominant in Gangetic plain.

- Material culture include use of burnt bricks, iron tools and weapons and other artefacts, punch marked coins, NBPW pottery.

Mauryans were the first to construct ring wells in the Gangetic region.

- 2**
- Ashoka maintain **intimate contact with tribals through the DHAMMA** mahamtras.
 - He launched **deliberate and systematic policy of acculturation.**
 - His policy was successful policy which **enabled the tribal to adopt higher culture** even fisherman, hunter practiced Dhamma and adopted settled agricultural life.

MAURYAN DYNASTY

(321 BC TO 185 BC)

SIGNIFICANCE

2

ADMINISTRATIVE SIGNIFICANCE

- 1 Mauryan empire gave **institutionalized structure to administration**. King was guided by the law laid down in the Dharma shashtra and the prevailing customs.
- 2 This is the first time in the History where we can see “**structured justice system**”.
- 3 No other periods in the ancient history had as many officers as Mauryans. Mauryans had 34 separate **department** with each department headed by Bureaucrats.
- 4 Administrative system was **backed by elaborate espionage**.

MAURYAN DYNASTY

(321 BC TO 185 BC)

SIGNIFICANCE

3 GEOGRAPHICAL SIGNIFICANCE



1 First kingdom to control whole of Indian subcontinent (except far south.)

2 This empire stretching from Kandhar in the west, Himalayas in the north and Kaveri river in the south.

MAURYAN DYNASTY

(321 BC TO 185 BC)

SIGNIFICANCE

4

ECONOMIC SIGNIFICANCE



LIFE-SIZE STANDING
IMAGE OF YAKSHI



LION CAPITAL

1

The rule also marks the important transition from use of wood to stone.

2

- New occupation in the form of Stone masonry were introduced.
- Highly technical skills were achieved by artisans in polishing stone pillars.
- Transport of such heavy monolithic pillars indicates such a great feat of engineering.

MAURYAN DYNASTY

(321 BC TO 185 BC)

SIGNIFICANCE

4 ECONOMIC SIGNIFICANCE

3 Both **internal and external trade** flourished.

4 Punch marked coins were issued with certain marks like hill, tree, fish and crescent.



TREE



3 ARCHED
HILLS



SUN



DHARMA
CHAKRA

5 They **learnt the art of making steel** through which it was easier to clear the forests and adopt better method of cultivation.

6 To bring virgin soil under cultivation. Kautilya advised to provide new peasants with **remission in taxes and supply with seeds and money.**



Q & A

- Q.1** With reference to the guilds (*shreni*) of ancient India that played a very important role in the country's economy, which of the following statements is/are correct?
- i. Every guild was registered with the central authority of the state and the king was the chief administrative authority on them.
 - ii. The wages, rules of work, standards and prices were fixed by the guild.
 - iii. The guild had judicial powers over its own members.

Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

- a) i and ii only
- b) iii only
- c) ii and iii only
- d) i, ii and iii

ANSWER d)

Q & A

Q.2 Who among the following presided over the Buddhist Council held during the reign of Ashoka at Pataliputra?

- a) Parsva
- b) Nagarjuna
- c) Moggaliputra Tissa
- d) Vasumitra

ANSWER c)

Q & A

Q.3 A term “BHESHAJAS” was used in the ancient history for:-

- a) Doctors
- b) Potters
- c) Merchant class
- d) Spies

ANSWER a)



Learning Space

THOUGHT PROVOKING QUESTIONS**Q.1**

Do you think economic factors alone were responsible for disintegration of Mauryan empire?

Q.2

Determine the extent of Mauryan empire?

Q.3

**How the Mauryan empire can be called as “Umbrella Empire”?
Highlights the footprint of this mighty empire.**

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